Enforcing Mandatory Fields Using UI Policies and Migrating Changes with Update Sets

Problem Statement:

This initiative aims to address the issue of incomplete data entry by implementing UI Policies to enforce mandatory fields based on specific conditions. Additionally, Update Sets are utilized to capture and migrate these configurations, ensuring consistent and error-free deployment across different environments.

Objective:

The objective of this initiative is to ensure accurate and complete data entry by enforcing mandatory fields through UI Policies. It also aims to facilitate the smooth and reliable migration of configurations across different environments using Update Sets

Literature Review:

Existing systems rely on manual validation or scripts to ensure data accuracy, which can be complex and error-prone. Previous studies highlight the importance of automated validation and structured deployment methods in improving system efficiency and reliability.

Methodology

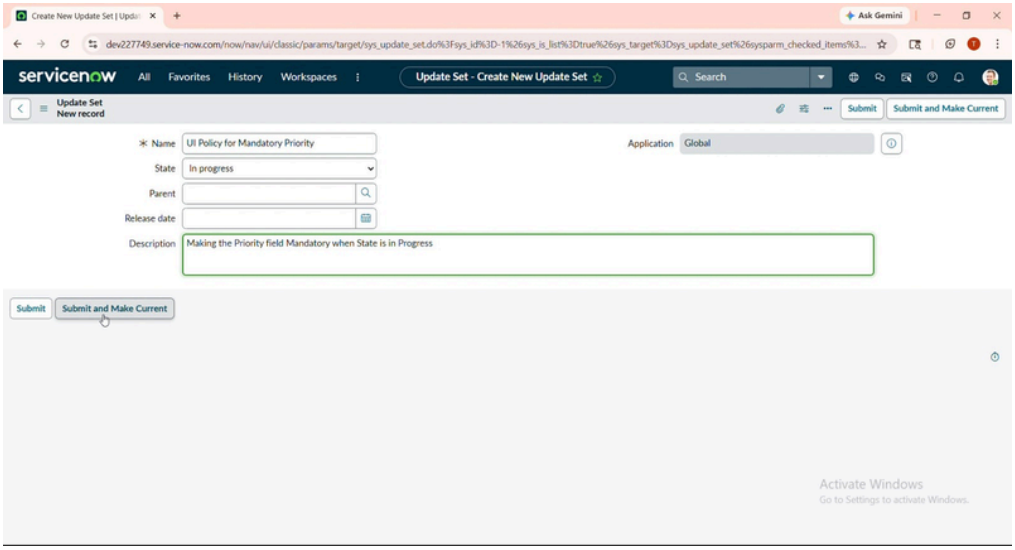
The approach involves creating UI Policies to enforce mandatory fields based on specific conditions. Update Sets are used to capture all configuration changes and migrate them systematically between instances.

TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Update Sets

Activity 1: Create Update Set

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Update Sets
3. Select Local Update Sets
4. Click on new
5. Fill the details below and make current.

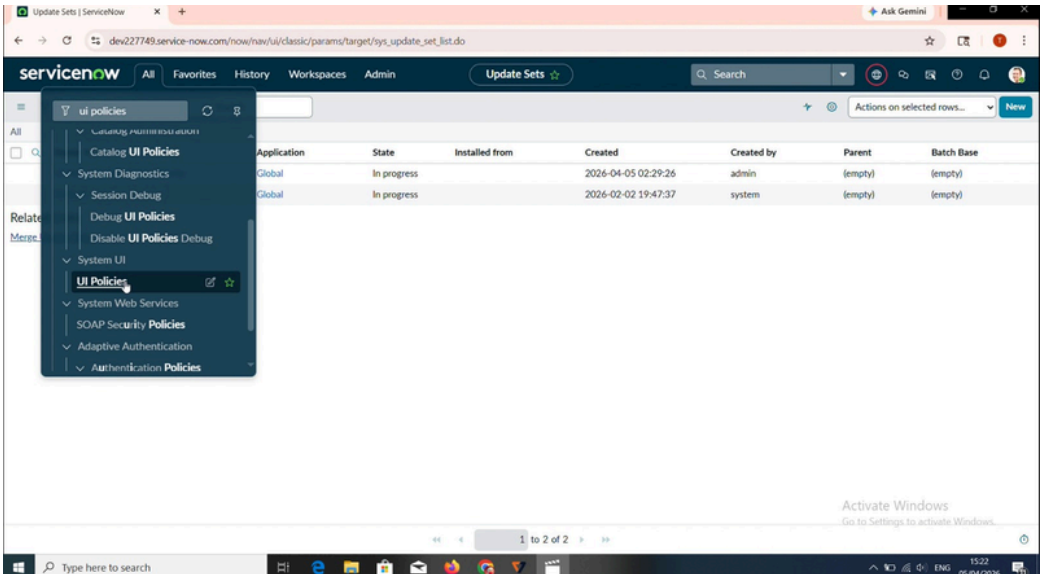


6. Click on submit

Milestone 2 : UI Policy

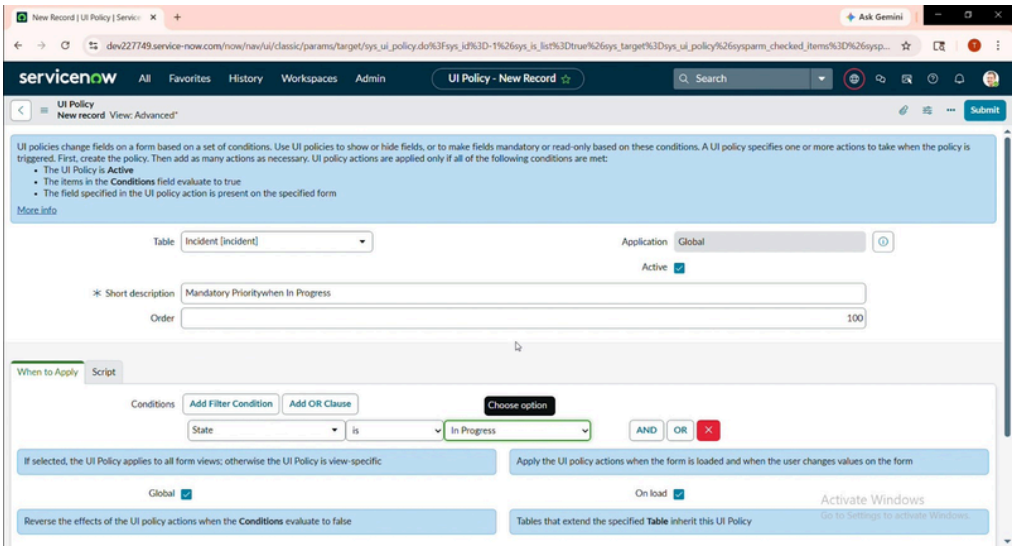
Activity 1: Create UI Policy

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for ui policies
3. Navigate to System UI >> UI Policies
4. Click on new



5.Fill the following details and Save

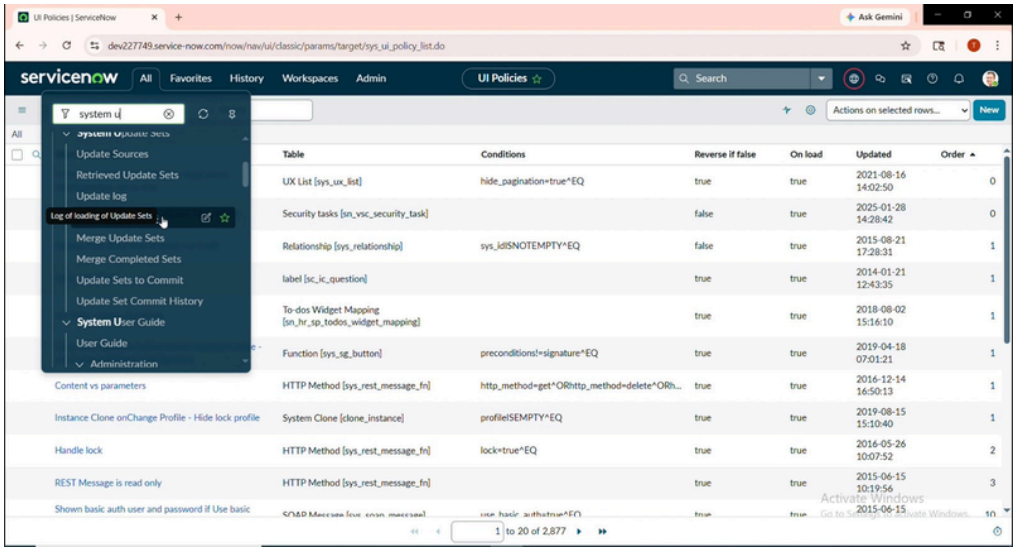
6.Scroll Down and add ‘priority’ Field on Ui policy Actions

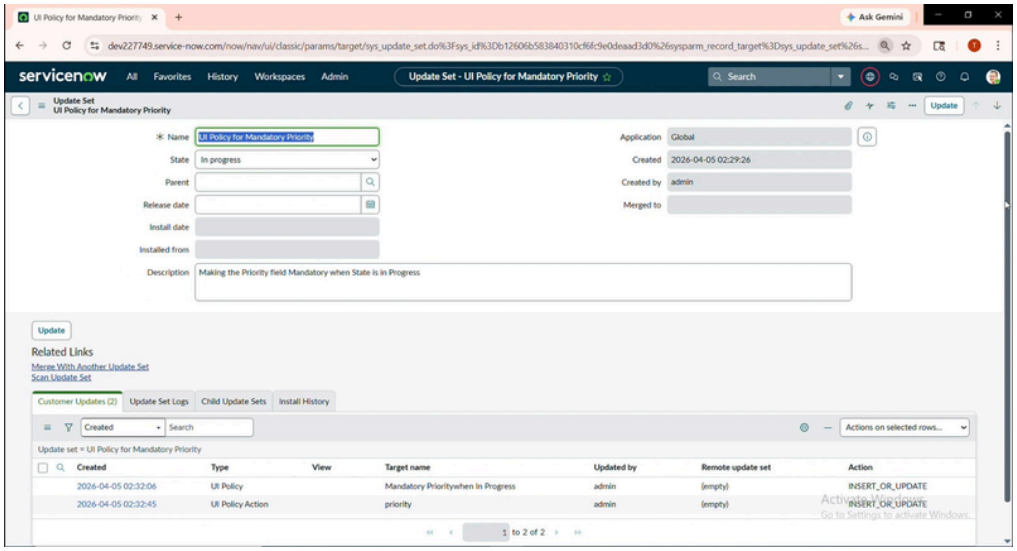


7.Click on submit.

Activity 2 : Check Update Set

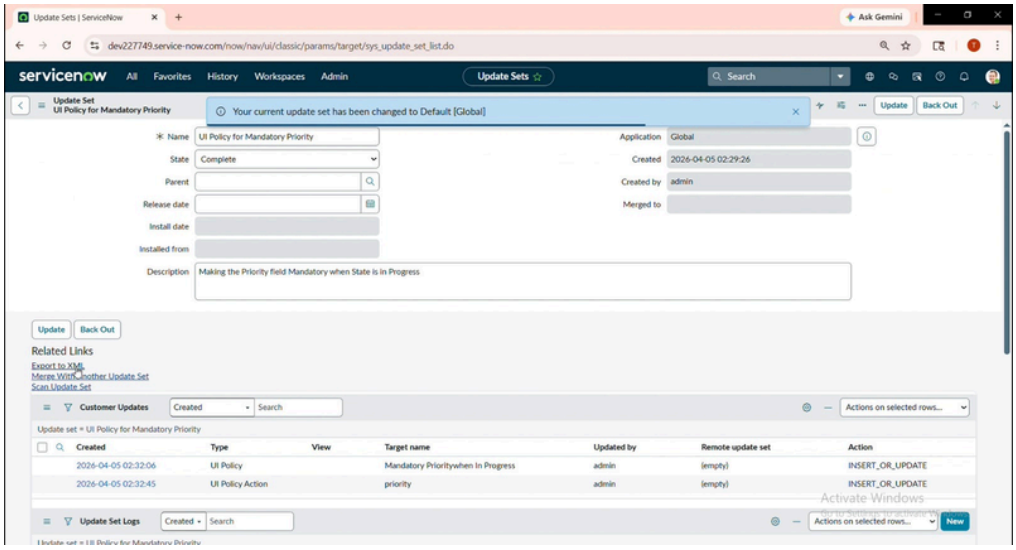
1. Navigate to the System Update Sets > Local Update Sets.
2. Open the ‘Ui policy for mandatory priority’ Update Set.
3. Verify that your UI Policy and UI Policy Action are listed.



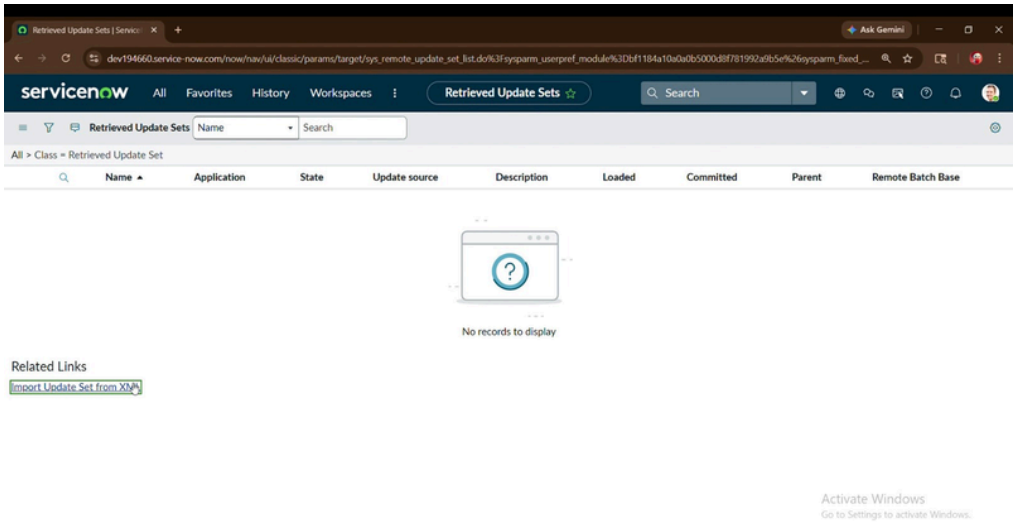


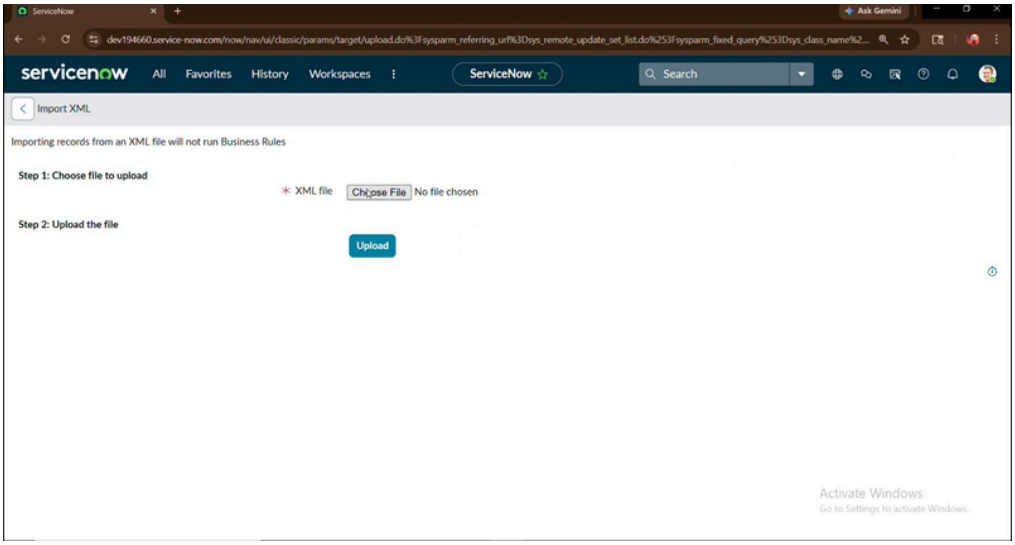
Activity 3 : Export and Import the Update Set

1.Set State to Complete and Click Export to XML on the Update Set record.
2.Download the XML file.

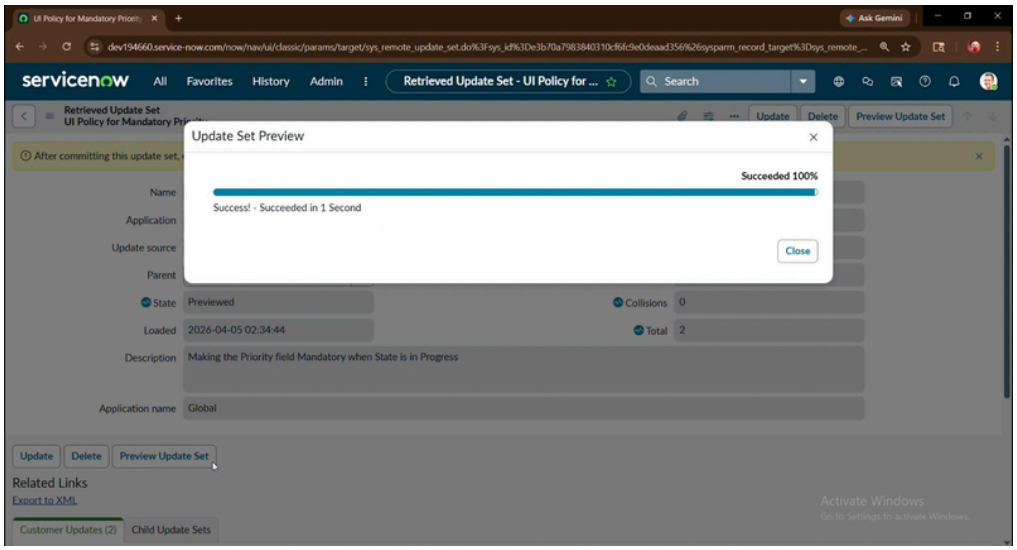


3.Now Open Another Instance to Export Update Set.
4.Go to System Update Sets >> Retrieved Update Sets.
5.Click on the Import update set from XML and Select File and Upload



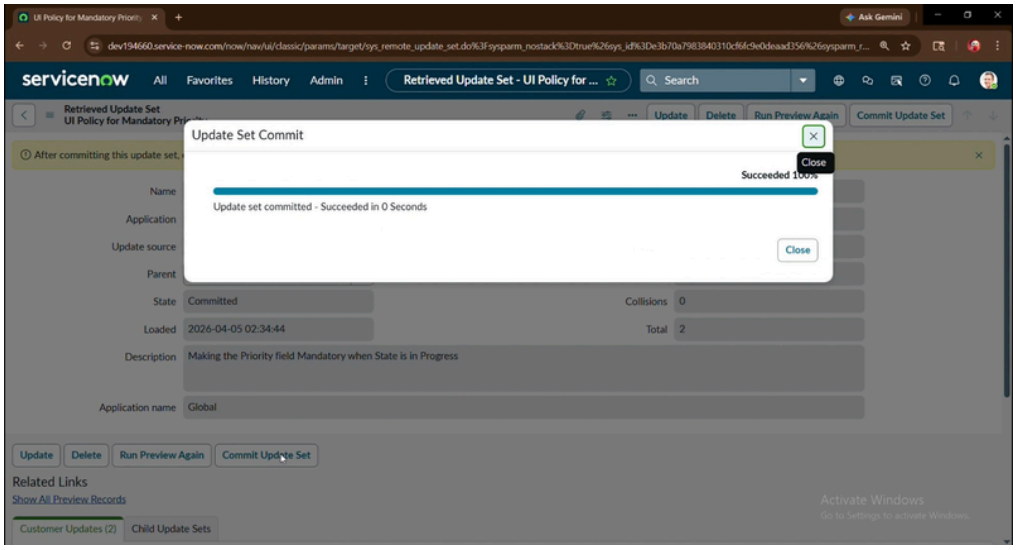


6.Open the update set that you have created in your instance here.



7.Preview the Update Set.

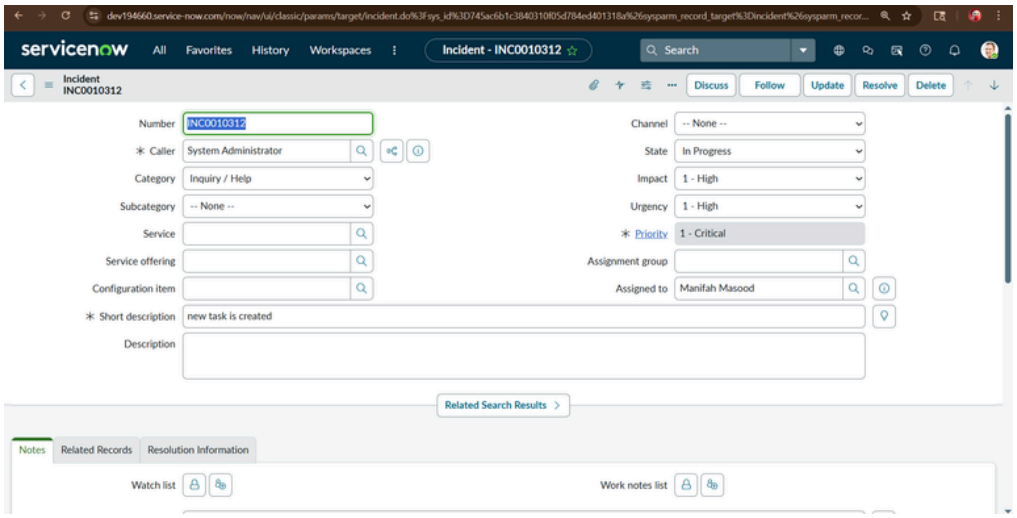
8.Commit the Update Set.



Milestone 3 : Result

Activity 1: Testing Incident

1.Go to the incident module.
2.Open an existing incident or create a new one.
3.Change the State is In-progress
4.The Priority field should now be mandatory



Conclusion

This project effectively demonstrates the use of UI Policies to enforce business rules in a dynamic and configuration-driven manner, eliminating the need for custom scripting and preserving platform stability. By enforcing the Priority field as mandatory when an incident transitions to the In Progress state, the solution ensures data completeness at a critical point in the incident lifecycle, leading to better prioritization, improved operational visibility, and more consistent workflow execution. In addition, the use of Update Sets to capture, review, and migrate all configuration changes highlights best practices for controlled deployment and environment management in ServiceNow. Together, these practices showcase a scalable, upgrade-safe approach to form behaviour control and configuration governance that can be reliably applied across multiple instances.

Future Scope

The system can be enhanced by adding advanced validation methods like Data Policies and automation using workflows or Flow Designer. Reporting dashboards can be introduced to monitor data quality. Additionally, integrating Update Sets with version control or CI/CD pipelines can improve deployment and tracking. User interface improvements can also be made to reduce errors and enhance usability.

References

ServiceNow Official Documentation
ServiceNow UI Policies Documentation
ServiceNow Update Sets Documentation

THANK YOU